

the bakery got write-ups in several newspapers and food blogs, bringing more attention to them and their products.

By the time I met Esther, the bakery was a smash hit. She and Ed had opened two additional locations in Toronto and were seeking capital to expand into other provinces. I looked at the cash flow and was blown away. Needless to say, I was very interested in their business plan!

I asked Esther how she did it—how she never failed to make smart financial choices that catapulted her and her husband from rags to riches in a little over a decade. “Financial independence for both partners, in perpetuity,” she told me, with a sly smile. “Isn’t that the way?”

Esther didn’t need me to give her advice. She was money-wise all on her own. In fact, she was financially aware the minute she got married—and every minute since. Best of all, she used her money smarts to strengthen her partnership with Ed. They didn’t just build a marriage. They built a family dynasty that will provide security and happiness for many years to come.

QUIZ: ARE YOU FINANCIALLY INDEPENDENT IN YOUR MARRIAGE?

Whose story sounds most like yours—Katrina’s or Esther’s? My goal is to help you move toward Esther on the financial independence spectrum. To figure out exactly how independent or dependent you are, try the quiz below.

1. Do you have a separate savings and/or checking account from your partner or spouse?Y/N
2. Are you aware of the various financial products available to you, and have you invested diversely across stocks, bonds, GICs and mutual funds?